CURRICULUM VITAE

Rowen Seykora
719 838 2142
View portfolio.

EDUCATION

2013 – 2017 Rochester Institute of Technology
B.S. in Molecular Biosciences

PUBLICATIONS

2023 Wiens, K.E., Iyer, A.S., Bhuiyan, T.R., Lu, L.L., Cizmeci, D., Gorman, M.J., Yuan, D., Becker, R.L., Ryan, E.T., Calderwood, S.B., et al. (2023). Predicting Vibrio cholerae infection and symptomatic disease: a systems serology study. The Lancet Microbe 4, e228–e235. https://doi.org/10.1016/s2666-5247(22)00391-3.

2022 Arora, A., Castro-Gutierrez, R., Moffatt, C., Eletto, D., Becker, R., Brown, M., Moor, A.E., Russ, H.A., and J. Matthew Taliaferro (2022). High-throughput identification of RNA localization elements in neuronal cells. Nucleic Acids Research 50, 10626–10642. https://doi.org/10.1093/nar/gkac763.

2020 Charles, R.C., Kelly, M., Tam, J.M., Akter, A., Hossain, M., Islam, K., Biswas, R., Kamruzzaman, M., Chowdhury, F., Khan, A.I., et al. (2020). Humans Surviving Cholera Develop Antibodies against Vibrio cholerae O-Specific Polysaccharide That Inhibit Pathogen Motility. mBio 11. https://doi.org/10.1128/mbio.02847-20.

2020 Marquis, K.A., Becker, R.L., Weiss, A.N., Morris, M.C., and Ferran, M.C. (2020). The VSV matrix protein inhibits NF-κB and the interferon response independently in mouse L929 cells. Virology 548, 117–123. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.virol.2020.06.013.

2019 Weil, A.A., Becker, R.L., and Harris, J.B. (2019). Vibrio cholerae at the Intersection of Immunity and the Microbiome. mSphere 4. https://doi.org/10.1128/mSphere.00597-19.

2019 Ritter, A.S., Chowdhury, F., Franke, M.F., Becker, R.L., Bhuiyan, T.R., Khan, A.I., Saha, N.C., Ryan, E.T., Calderwood, S.B., LaRocque, R.C., et al. (2019). Vibriocidal Titer and Protection From Cholera in Children. Open Forum Infectious Diseases 6. https://doi.org/10.1093/ofid/ofz057.

ABSTRACTS/PRESENTATIONS

2018 Ritter, A., Chowdhury, F., Becker, R., Bhuiyan, T., Khan, A., Ryan, E.T., Calderwood, S.B., LaRocque, R., Harris, J., Qadri, F., et al. (2018). 1105. Vibriocidal titer variation and likelihood of protection in children compared with adults in a cholera endemic area. Open Forum Infectious Diseases 5, S331–S331. https://doi.org/10.1093/ofid/ofy210.939.

TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION EXPERIENCE

2026 (Present) **Science Writer (Community Contributor**)
The Life Raft Group (patient advocacy & research for rare cancers such as GIST and liposarcoma)

- Work sample: Highlights from the American Society of Clinical Oncology (ASCO) Annual Meeting Recap Webinar
- Levies on an ever-growing insight into gastrointestinal stromal tumors (GISTs), a class of soft tissue sarcomas, to translate complex biomedical literature into accessible prose for newly diagnosed patients and their family members.
- Authors content from the intersection of technical rigor and empathy to encourage research participation and empower patients with a greater understanding of their condition.
- Acts as a bridge between cancer biologists, medical professionals, and patient networks to transmit research discoveries from their source to those most directly affected, ensuring audience accessibility without compromising accuracy.

2023 - 2025 **Technical Sales & Account Manager**

Thermo Fisher Scientific, Raynmaker (Agentic AI for small businesses focused on animal health)

- Served as a trusted technical resource across small-business technology and life sciences, conducting in-depth consultations to assess client needs and translate complex technical offerings into clear, tailored solutions.
- Maintained meticulous records and follow-up documentation in structured CRM databases for thousands of contacts, ensuring continued engagement with clients' evolving research needs across varied, high-volume portfolios.

2022 **Science Writer and Content Developer**

Slingshot Biosciences

- Led content development for the launch of flow cytometry and synthetic cell biology reagents, producing educational writing, scientific figures, application notes, and articles that communicated product value to both scientific and commercial audiences.
- Collaborated cross-functionally with the R&D team, leveraging proficiency in data interpretation and scientific literature review to distill experimental findings into nuanced, plain-language insights that directly informed and strengthened messaging.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

2020 – 2021 **Molecular Biology Research Associate**

University of Colorado, Anschutz Medical Campus

- Contributed to research in neuronal cells validating and examining active oligonucleotide sequences within 3′ UTRs found to be sufficient and necessary to drive localization of their transcripts to neurites. This established the groundwork for identification of RNA-binding proteins (RBPs) such as Unk (Unkempt), as associated with relevant sequence elements and required for efficient localization of the studied transcripts to neurites.
- Built upon a workflow for smFISH (Fluorescence in situ hybridization) image data capture and analysis, improving the accuracy and completeness of spacial visualization of relevant RNAs in cells with complex, elongated morphology.
- Communicated research findings through presentations and written reports for both scientific peers and a broader community of molecular biologists, translating technical results into clear, structured narratives.

2017 – 2019 **Microbiology Research Technician II**

Massachusetts General Hospital (MGH) Division of Infectious Diseases

- Created a comprehensive epidemiological database by consolidating and analyzing pertinent information for approximately 800 cholera patients and their 1700 plus household contacts collected over the course of two decades.
- Contributed to an ongoing systems serology-based initiative to identify novel humoral correlates of protection against infection with *Vibrio cholerae* by providing expertise in high throughput analysis of results and by performing a variety of assays such as Ig Luminex, ELISA, Antibody-dependent cellular phagocytosis assays, and others that measure functional activity of antibodies in convalescent Cholera-patient serum.
- Conducted serosurveillance of cholera endemic areas such as several sites in Haiti, and Dhaka, Bangladesh by conducting high-throughput sample evaluation by real time qPCR, multiplex PCR, ELISA and vibriocidal titer assays.
- Mentored and instructed research students, as well as guided incoming research technicians throughout their initial training.
- Devised new protocols, upgraded existing methods, and authored highly detailed SOPs.
- Managed working order of the lab by procuring necessary reagents and supplies, maintaining and purchasing new equipment, and cataloging samples received by the lab.